

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Succession decision tree

START -> newly exposed substrate or disturbed former community

NO DEVELOPED SOIL -> primary succession pathway

SOIL AND BIOLOGICAL LEGACIES REMAIN -> secondary succession pathway

DRIVERS -> autogenic community change plus allogenic external forcing

OUTCOME -> contingent trajectory, not one guaranteed endpoint

MUST REMEMBER: Succession is directional community change driven by colonisation,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Primary succession rail

BARE OR NEW SUBSTRATE -> pioneer establishment

WEATHERING AND ORGANIC INPUT -> initial soil development

HERBS OR OTHER COLONISTS -> more cover and resource capture

LATER COMMUNITIES -> increasing structural complexity where conditions permit

LIMIT -> no universal species list or completion time

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Secondary succession rail

DISTURBANCE -> prior vegetation reduced or removed

SOIL, ROOTS, SEEDS OR MICROBES REMAIN -> biological legacy

RAPID COLONISERS -> early recovery

COMPETITION AND RECRUITMENT -> later community change

LIMIT -> faster than primary does not mean instant or identical recovery

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Sere vocabulary map

SERE -> complete sequence at one site

SERAL STAGE -> one community within the sequence

LITHOSERE -> rock PSAMMOSERE -> sand

HALOSERE -> saline HYDROSERE -> fresh water

XEROSERE -> dry substrate; names identify starts, not fixed ends

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Hydrarch and xerarch comparison

HYDRARCH -> begins in water or very wet substrate

XERARCH -> begins under dry conditions

BOTH -> may trend toward more mesic regional conditions

PATH -> depends on sediment, soil, colonists and disturbance

CAUTION -> convergence is not one universal sequence

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Mechanism fork

AUTOGENIC -> organisms alter litter, soil, shade or microclimate

ALLOGENIC -> flood, fire, erosion, deposition, climate or land use acts externally

FACILITATION -> early species improve later establishment

INHIBITION OR TOLERANCE -> alternative replacement mechanisms

RULE -> identify the driver before naming the mechanism

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Primary is not secondary succession, pioneer is not universally...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Climax theory pressure test

CLASSICAL CLAIM -> regional climate favours a relatively stable climax

PRESSURE -> disturbance history and species arrival differ among sites

MODERN READING -> multiple plausible stable states can occur

DISTURBANCE -> redirects or resets trajectories

VERDICT -> climate constrains but does not uniquely script every endpoint

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Restoration staging ladder

- 1 STABILISE -> erosion, substrate and hydrology
- 2 REBUILD FUNCTION -> organic matter, soil biota and nutrient processes
- 3 ENABLE NATIVE RECRUITMENT -> propagules and suitable microclimate
- 4 RECOVER STRUCTURE -> composition, layering and connectivity
- 5 MONITOR -> function and trajectory, not planting count alone

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Scale vocabulary

HABITAT -> place used by a species

ECOSYSTEM -> bounded interacting biotic and abiotic functional unit

BIOME -> broad regional ecological category

FOREST LEGAL CATEGORY -> status under applicable law or interpretation

RULE -> one term cannot silently substitute for another

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Biome control matrix

BROAD CLIMATE -> temperature and precipitation pattern

SOIL AND TOPOGRAPHY -> local water and nutrient conditions

FIRE AND HERBIVORY -> maintain or redirect open vegetation

LAND-USE HISTORY -> modifies present composition

BOUNDARY -> biome maps are gradients, not exact site-level lines

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Open ecosystem firewall

GRASSLAND, SAVANNA, SCRUB -> may be natural ecological states

WASTELAND -> administrative or revenue label

FOREST -> legal category in the relevant context

PLANTATION -> land-cover intervention, not proof of restored biome

DECISION -> assess native biome before afforestation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ and monitoring boundary

2021 ROUTE -> pioneers surviving on surfaces without soil

2024 ESSAY -> forests and deserts used as a qualified ecological warning

FOREST COVER -> canopy trend, not successional-stage proof

RESTORATION CLAIM -> needs repeated composition, soil and function evidence

LIVE STUB -> adds no succession timeline, biome range or status

EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State initial substrate, disturbance...